greymetre

BUSINESS GUIDE



Five Signs Your Channel Is Quietly Choosing Someone Else

Why dealers, retailers and mechanics drift away, and what changes when loyalty is run as a lever, not a cost.

5
warning signs

10-point
scorecard

10 min
read

WHY THIS GUIDE

Most manufacturers don't lose share in one big loss. They lose it one partner at a time.

Dealers keep billing but buy less of your range. Retailers stock you but push a rival. Mechanics, electricians and painters recommend whoever reached them last. It happens one dealer, one retailer, one mechanic at a time, quietly.

Meanwhile, loyalty schemes run and points are paid, yet nobody can say what they returned. Primary billing looks fine for months. Secondary sales and share tell a different story, but only once the year has closed.

This guide covers five warning signs that engagement, not your product or your price, is the constraint, and what changes when loyalty is run as a lever, not a cost.

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01 SIGN ONE

Channel attrition is quietly eating secondary sales

If dealers drift away one by one, primary billing hides it for months. By the time it shows, the share is already gone.

What it looks like

- Dealers stay on the books but order less, and less often.
- Dormant dealers are noticed only at the year-end review.
- Nobody is alerted when a top dealer's orders start to drop.
- Win-back is a phone call from the sales head, not a process.

What it costs

Share is lost slowly enough that no one owns it. Each dealer looks like a small loss, so nobody acts, and a rival takes the counter before anyone calls.

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

A churn early-warning agent flags drift in secondary sales week by week, dealer by dealer. It puts a win-back action on someone's list within 48 hours, so the right dealer gets a call before the next order goes elsewhere.

02 SIGN TWO

Dealer expansion isn't turning into retailer movement

If you keep appointing dealers but retail counters don't grow, stock is moving into the channel, not through it.

What it looks like

- New dealers are appointed, but the number of retail counters stays the same.
- Stock moves from you to the dealer and stops there.
- Retailers stock your range but recommend a rival's.
- Nobody measures sell-out below the dealer.

What it costs

More partners and more stock in the channel, but no more share. Dealer credit stretches while the retailer sells someone else.

CLIENT EXAMPLE · JAMNA AUTO, AUTO OEM AND AFTERMARKET

We identified and onboarded key mechanics as advocates and widened product availability across regions. **35,000 active mechanics, 25,000 active retailers, aftermarket share from 11% to 18%.**

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

Multi-tier programmes reach past the dealer to retailers, with sell-out captured by QR or invoice. Engagement is measured where the sale actually happens, not where the stock was billed.

03 SIGN THREE

Your loyalty programme feels like a cost, not a lever

If the scheme pays every partner the same way, it mostly rewards what you would have sold anyway.

What it looks like

- The same points scheme runs for every partner, big or small.
- Rewards are paid on purchases you would have got anyway.
- Top performers get the same treatment as everyone else.
- Scheme returns are never measured, so last year's scheme simply repeats.

What it costs

A loyalty budget that grows every year with no link to share. Finance sees only a cost line, and the scheme becomes the first thing to cut.

> **Raymond, branded fabric:** the PRIDE loyalty programme took active retailers up 30% and grew the dealer network 95%.

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

A scheme optimiser compares each scheme's return and retunes it, so spend moves to the partners and behaviours that grow share. Top performers earn more, and the rest have a reason to climb a tier.

04 SIGN FOUR

Influencers recommend whoever reached them last

If mechanics, electricians or painters choose the brand at the counter, they decide your share, not the retailer.

What it looks like

- Mechanics, electricians, plumbers or painters decide the brand at the counter.
- You know only a fraction of them by name.
- Rivals run meets, apps and rewards for them. You run an annual event.
- Counterfeit parts take the credit for your brand.

What it costs

The person who chooses the product is not engaged with you. Rivals win the recommendation, and every counterfeit fitted in your name wears down trust in the genuine part.

> **Gajra Gears, auto gears:** an aftermarket mechanic programme with 50,000+ mechanics enrolled.

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

Influencer programmes with QR-coded genuine-part rewards and a WhatsApp channel enrol and engage influencers at scale. Every claim is verified, so you reward the people who fit your product, not the ones who fit a copy.

05 SIGN FIVE

Scheme spend rises, and nobody can say what it returned

If claims are paid on trust and returns are never reported, the loyalty budget is a leak, not an investment.

What it looks like

- Claims are paid on unverified secondary data.
- The same redemption shows up twice, and nobody catches it.
- Finance caps the budget because the return is unclear.
- Campaigns run in one region and are never compared with another.

What it costs

Money leaks out of the programme through duplicate and inflated claims. Then the budget gets cut just when it should grow, and the channel notices.

WHAT RARE OS CHANGES

A claim anomaly detector holds suspect redemptions before they are paid. Every scheme reports its return on a named scorecard, so finance can see what the money bought and fund what works.

THE ALTERNATIVE

What changes when loyalty runs as a lever

Your partners stay the same. What changes is who is enrolled, what earns a reward, and how fast drift and leakage are caught.

	Engagement today	Engagement on RARE OS
Who is enrolled	Dealers, on paper	Dealers, retailers and influencers
What earns points	Purchases	Sell-out and behaviour that grows share
Scheme design	Same for everyone	Tiered and retuned by return
Claims	Paid on trust	Verified, anomalies held
Drift	Seen at year-end	Flagged weekly, dealer by dealer
Channel to partners	Calls and circulars	WhatsApp, in one system



Three agents behind the programme

Churn early-warning: flags drifting partners every week.

Scheme optimiser: retunes each scheme by its return.

Claim anomaly detector: holds suspect redemptions before payout.

It sits on top of your ERP. It is called RARE OS, an operating system for moving market share. Most companies start with one region or one partner tier.

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Scorecard: where do you stand?

Tick each statement that is true for your channel today.

- [ ] 01 Some dealers order less each quarter and nobody is alerted.
- [ ] 02 We notice dormant dealers only at year-end.
- [ ] 03 New dealers have not added retail counters.
- [ ] 04 We do not measure sell-out below the dealer.
- [ ] 05 Our loyalty scheme is the same for every partner.
- [ ] 06 We cannot say what our schemes returned.
- [ ] 07 We know few of our influencers by name.
- [ ] 08 Rivals run influencer programmes we do not.
- [ ] 09 Claims are paid without verification.
- [ ] 10 Finance has capped loyalty spend for lack of proof.

0–2 ticks

Your channel is engaged. Review schemes once a year.

3–5 ticks

Share is leaking through the channel. A focused pilot will show where.

6 or more

Engagement is now a constraint on market share.

NEXT STEPS

Start small, prove it, then scale

1. **Pick one region or one partner tier**
   Choose where drift or scheme spend worries you most.
2. **Map active, drifting and dormant partners**
   12 months of secondary sales and claims data are enough to start.
3. **Run one tiered scheme for a quarter**
   Verify every claim, and hold anomalies before payout.
4. **Measure, then scale**
   Track active partners and share before extending to the next region or tier.

Scored 3 or more? Get a free channel engagement health check.

In 30 minutes, we review your scorecard and show you where a tiered, verified programme would move share fastest. Built for you, owned by you. No obligation.

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calendly.com/anadi-greymetre/30min

EMAIL
anadi@greymetre.com

CALL
+91 91316 78419